

Citi - Intern Interview Experience

About the company

Citi is a global bank that offers a variety of financial services, including banking, credit cards, and investment solutions. It operates in more than 160 countries and values innovation, diversity, and teamwork, creating an inclusive workplace where employees can grow. Citi's mission is to help people, businesses, and communities achieve their financial goals.

Role: Application Developer

Stipend: 75,000 INR per month

Duration of internship: 8-10 weeks

1. Online test (12.10.2025)

The online test is conducted on the codility platform. It has 3 questions. Among them 2 were easy and 1 was medium difficulty.

1. Phonebook question - Easy

- Input format

```
{'Ram' : '123456',  
  'Sam' : '345689',  
  'Raju' : '8976'  
}
```

- Search : '456'
- The task is to find the name whose phone number contains the given substring '456'.
- If more than one phone number has the given substring we have to return the lexicographically smaller name.
- In this case the phone numbers of 'Ram' and 'Sam' both have the given substring '456'. So we have to return the lexicographically smaller name - 'Ram'.
- If the input is '897' then the answer will be 'Raju'.
- For this question they explicitly mentioned that there is no need to provide an optimal solution. Correctness is sufficient.

2. Minimum number for given Digit Sum - Easy

- Given integer X, find Y.
- 'Y' is the minimum number whose sum of digits is equal to 'X'
- Eg. If X=17, Y=89
- If X=46, Y=199999
- For this question they explicitly mentioned that there is no need to provide an optimal solution. Correctness is sufficient.

3. Find the maximum round reached by each player - Medium

- We will be given an array 'skills' which has the skill level of different players.
- The adjacent players will compete in each round.
- The player with the **higher skill** wins and moves on to the next round.
- The process continues until only one winner remains.
- We have to return the maximum round reached by a player.
- Example
skills = [2,7,6,3]
Result : max_round =[1,2,2,1]
- For this question they asked for an optimal solution .

2. Technical Interview (30-35 mins)

The technical interview was conducted at CUIC on 05/11/2025. There were nearly 80 candidates got shortlisted for technical interviews. Everyone was randomly assigned to panels. I was called for my first round in the afternoon at 2pm.

I was assigned to a panel of 2 interviewers. Both of them interacted with me throughout the interview. They first asked me to **introduce myself** and then they asked about my projects. I have done a realtime website for a startup. They were excited about it and asked several **questions related to that project**.

Then they asked about my **Joint Secretary** position at CSEA and **Events Organizer** position at CTF, since I mentioned them in my resume and self - Introduction.

Then they asked about my DBMS project and asked whether I was good at SQL. I said yes. So they asked me to write a **Simple SQL Query**.

Then they asked some **general questions**. Then I was given the chance to ask questions to them. I asked about the company's tech stack

and AI tools used. At the end they both wished me the best and the first round ended on a good note.

Questions related to project

- What are the key features of the project?
- They also asked some questions about specific features. (This part consumed most of the time in the interview. They asked almost everything about the project)
- Why didn't you suggest your client to use pre-established services like 'Justdial' for e-commerce. Why did you created a website for that when Justdial is there?
- What are the challenges you faced while developing this project?

Questions related to JS(CSEA) / Events(CTF)

- What is your responsibility in this position?
- Are you the only one in that role, or are there more people with you?
- Tell about your experience in working as a team.
- The same responsibility question is asked for CTF.
- Asked some general questions about kurukshetra.

Simple SQL Query

- It is a simple query. Basically I was asked to join two tables and retrieve the relevant rows.

General Questions

- When you are submitting your code for review, your manager says 'Your code is bad'. What will you do now?
- What was your favourite programming language?
- Do you have an idea of going to higher studies? I said no. Then they asked why? I expressed my interest in developing real time applications.
- Are you ready to relocate to Pune?

3. HR Round (25-30 mins)

I got called for the HR round within 7 minutes after I finished the technical round. In this panel there was only one interviewer. She first asked me to introduce myself and asked about my family members and my hometown. Then she asked about my previous internship experience. Then she asked about the flow of my project. I mentioned requirement gathering,

Prototyping, Periodic reviews. Then she asked how did you gather requirements? What are the specific strategies you follow? Tell about any specific challenge you faced while developing the project?

Why are you interested in joining citi?

Do you have an interest in application development? I said yes. Then she asked why?

Then she asked whether I got any opportunity to work in environments that integrate computer networking and application development. I said no and explained how networking concepts like protocols helped me to quickly grasp the web server communication fundamentals.

Consider you are working in a team and someone says 'no' to your idea. How did you handle that situation?

Consider while working as a team you have to say 'no' to your teammate's idea. How did you say that?

Then she asked Do I have any backlogs? Do any of my relatives work in citi? Am I ready to relocate to Pune? And am interested in pursuing higher studies?

At last, she wished me the best and suggested me to do research on networking + application development integrated systems and she told me that she worked on such systems and found them interesting.

After a few hours the results were released and **12 candidates** got selected for the internship and I was one among them :)

- In my experience, most of the questions were asked based on the resume
- The interviewers were very friendly and the interview felt like a casual conversation.
- The questions asked in the online round were also easy, but the submission time played a key role in shortlisting.
- Stay calm and try to be yourself in HR rounds.
- Never lie on your resume.
- Never lose hope. Stay consistent. Keep putting the efforts, it will be always rewarded. All the best :)

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